

Climate Science, UNFCCC & Paris Agreement

Greenhouse effect, NDCs, COP process and India's climate pledges — rising theme.

Portion focus ~52% · Topic: env-climate

PYQ themes: Paris Agreement · NDCs · COP outcomes · Mitigation/adaptation

Why UPSC asks this

Global agenda + India's diplomacy make this a rising high-chance block.

Science basics

GHGs, radiative forcing, carbon sinks, extreme events attribution language — keep conceptual.

Regime

Common but differentiated responsibilities spirit; Paris: NDCs, global stocktake, transparency. COP is the decision theatre — track headline outcomes for CA.

India angle

Energy transition, missions (solar etc.), climate finance asks, co-benefits with development.

Must remember

- UNFCCC !' Kyoto (binding for Annex I historically) !' Paris (NDCs, universal)
- Mitigation vs adaptation vs loss & damage vocabulary
- India: intensity reduction, non-fossil capacity, net-zero long-term framing — verify latest NDC numbers before exam